

About This Project

Master Plan & Development Code Update

WHO?

Richland Parish residents, businesses, and stakeholders.

WHAT?

A Comprehensive Master Plan and Development Code Update.

WHEN?

May 2026 – June 2027. A year-long process with multiple phases.

WHERE?

Richland Parish across all unincorporated areas.

WHY?

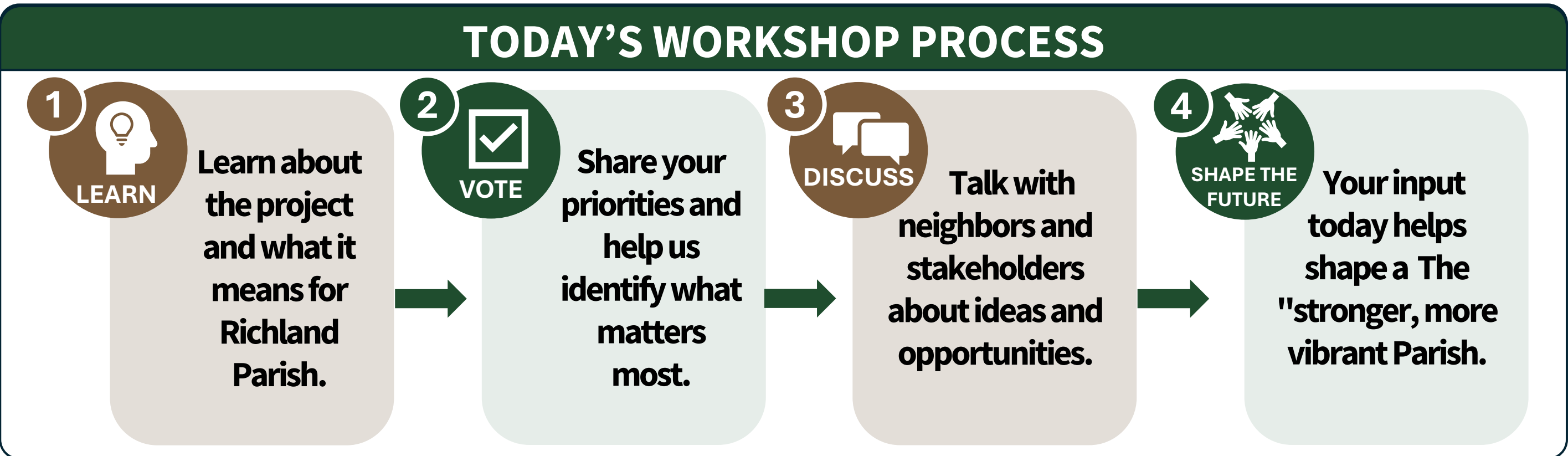
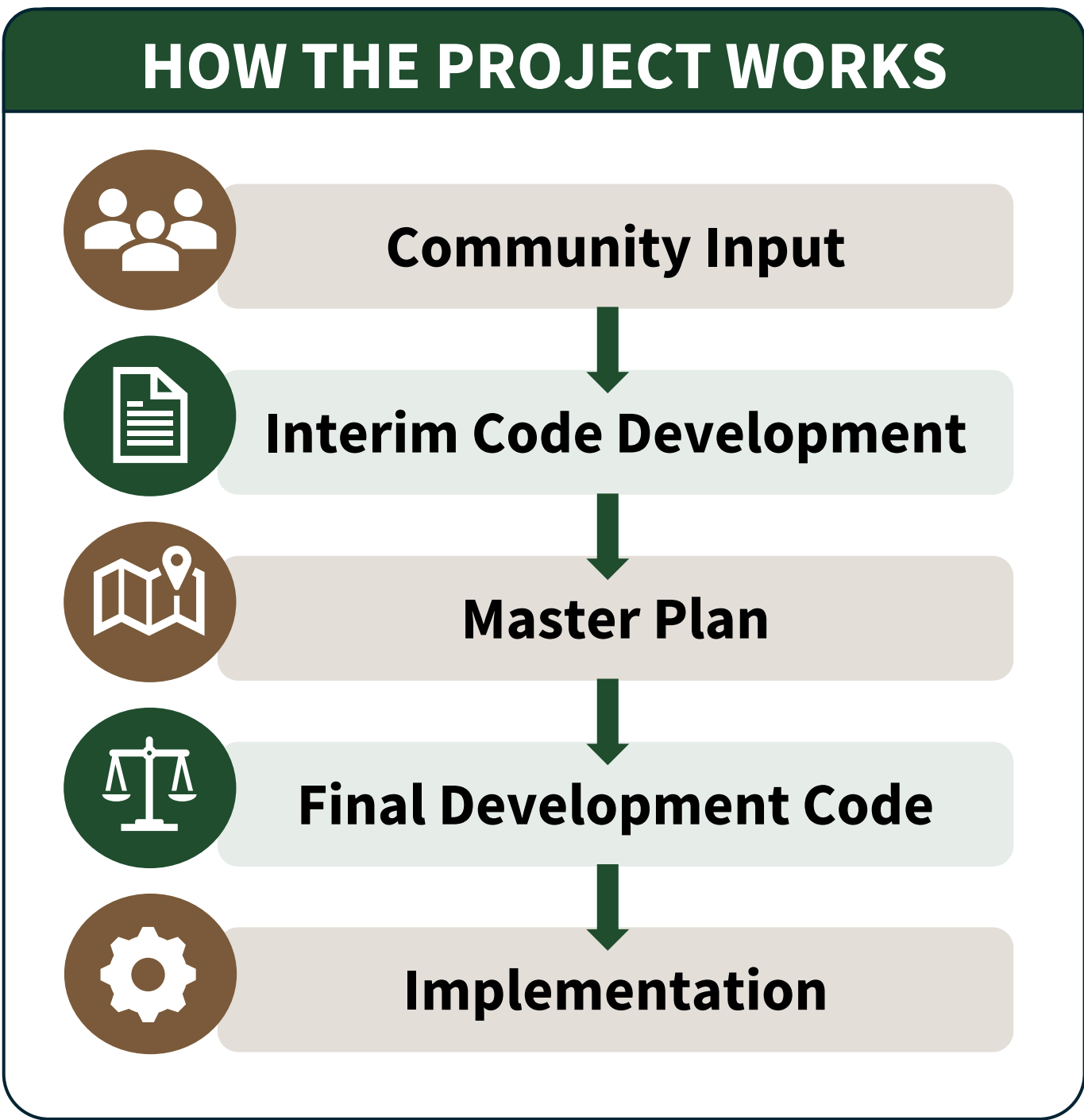
To build a stronger, more resilient, and vibrant future for our Parish.

WHAT IS A MASTER PLAN?

A Master Plan is a long-range vision for Richland Parish. It helps guide decisions about future growth, housing, transportation, infrastructure, economic development, community facilities, and conservation. The Master Plan establishes the direction and goals for the Parish's future.

WHAT IS A DEVELOPMENT CODE?

A Development Code is the set of rules used to guide how land is developed. It combines zoning regulations, subdivision requirements, and development standards into a single document adopted by the Parish. The code helps make development decisions more consistent, predictable, and easier to administer.



ABOUT TODAY'S WORKSHOP

Your Input Matters

This is an interactive community workshop designed to gather feedback on Richland Parish's future. We encourage you to share your ideas, concerns, and priorities. There are no right or wrong answers, and all feedback is valuable.

How the Workshop Works

There are 6 stations throughout the workshop that you can visit at your own pace.

- Stations do not need to be completed in a specific order.
- Spend as much or as little time at each station as you would like.
- Share your thoughts using stickers, maps, comment cards, and interactive activities.
- Feel free to explore independently.
- Project team members are available throughout the room if you have questions or would like to discuss a topic in more detail.

Thank You for Participating

Your feedback will help shape the Richland Parish Comprehensive Master Plan and Development Code and guide future decisions for the parish.

LOCATOR MAP

NOTE: This process focuses on the unincorporated parts of the Parish. The Plan and Development Code will not set standards or a vision for Rayville, Delhi, or Mangham. Residents of those towns can still give input, which will inform the Parish plan.

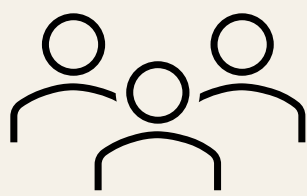
POLICE JURY DISTRICTS

- Municipalities Not Included in the Plan
- District 1
- District 2
- District 3
- District 4
- District 5
- District 6
- District 7
- District 8
- District 9
- Waterways
- Waterbodies

Scale: 0 1.75 3.5 7 Miles

19.8K

Total Population
0.4% of Louisiana's population.



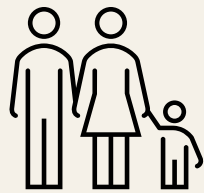
8.7K

Total Households
Represents approximately 0.5% of
Louisiana's households.



2.58

Average Household Size
Similar to state average of 2.5.



40.1

Median Age
Older than Louisiana's median
age of approximately 39 years.



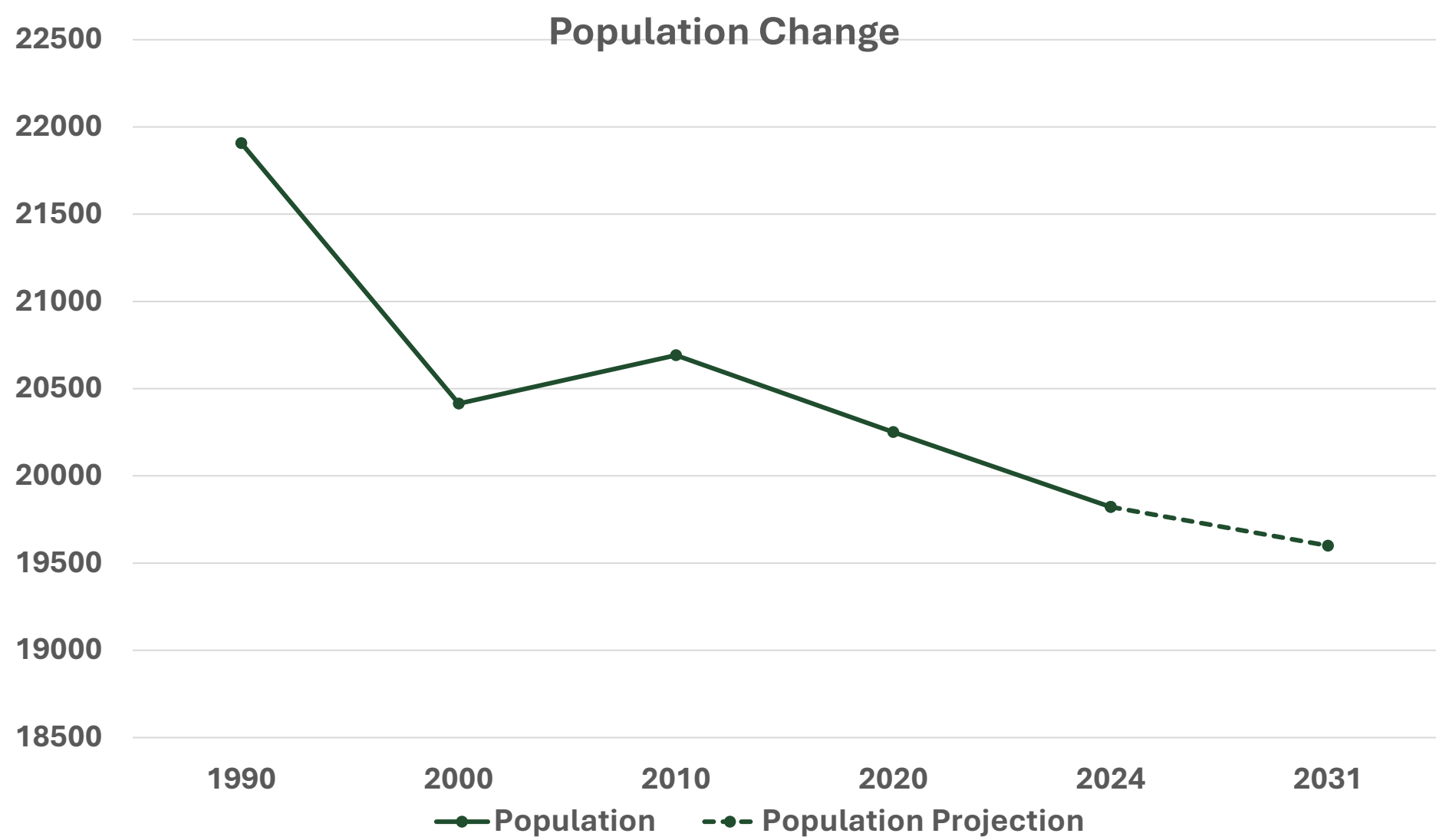
81%

High School Diploma or Higher
Slightly below Louisiana's average
of 88%.



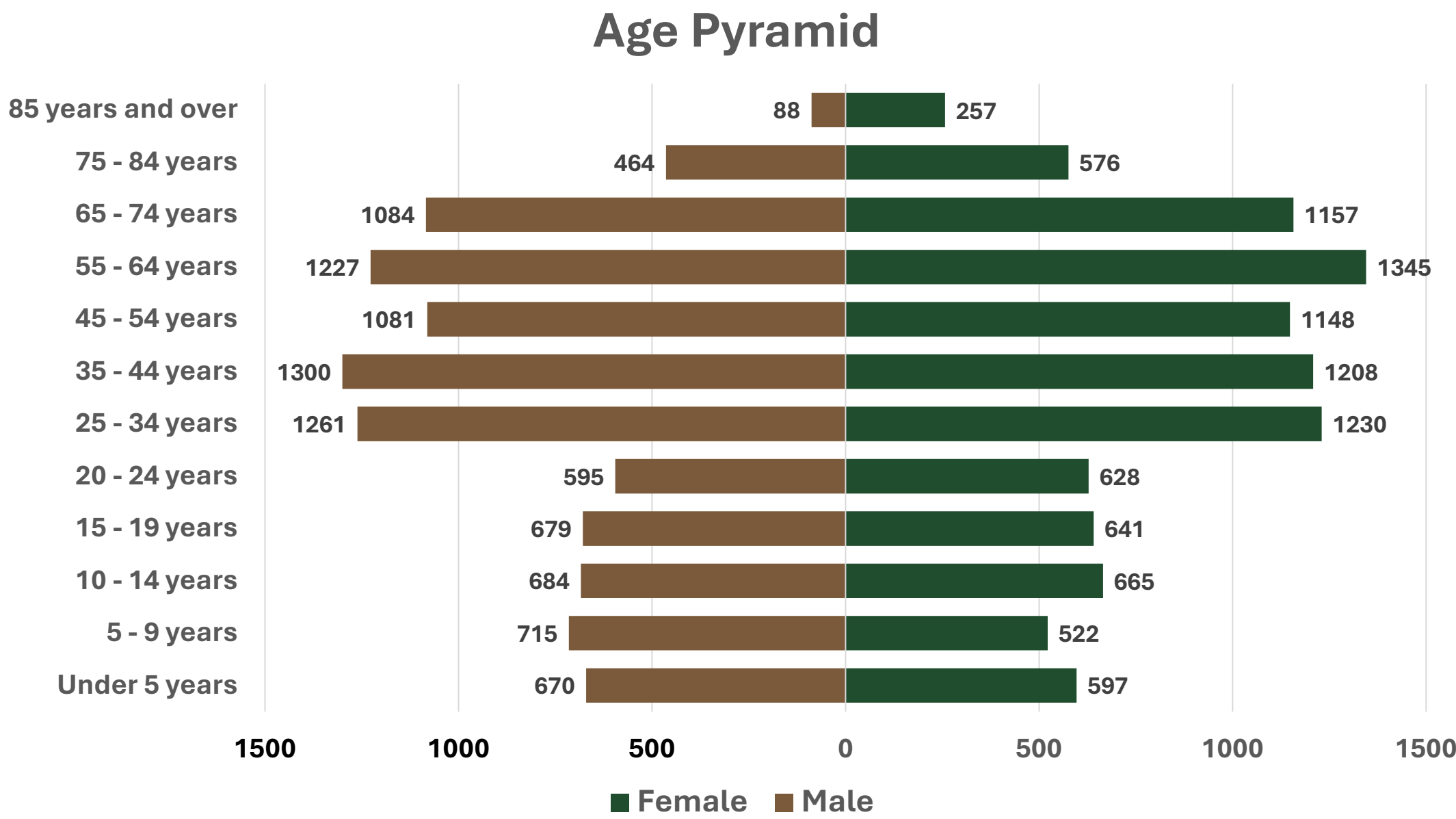
Understanding who lives in Richland Parish today helps us make better decisions about its future. The recommendations developed through this planning process should reflect the needs, priorities, and lifestyle of the people who call the Parish home. As you review the information below, consider how these demographic trends should influence future investments, policies, and community improvements.

POPULATION TRENDS



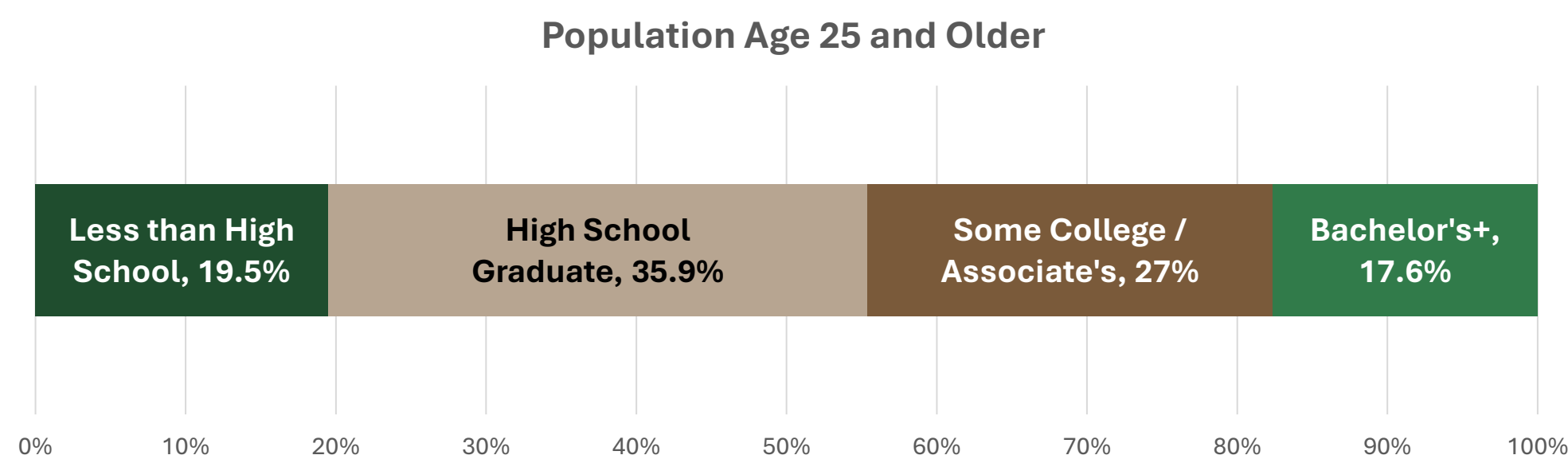
- Richland Parish has experienced a modest population decline since 1990.
- Population is projected to remain relatively stable through 2031.

AGE STRUCTURE



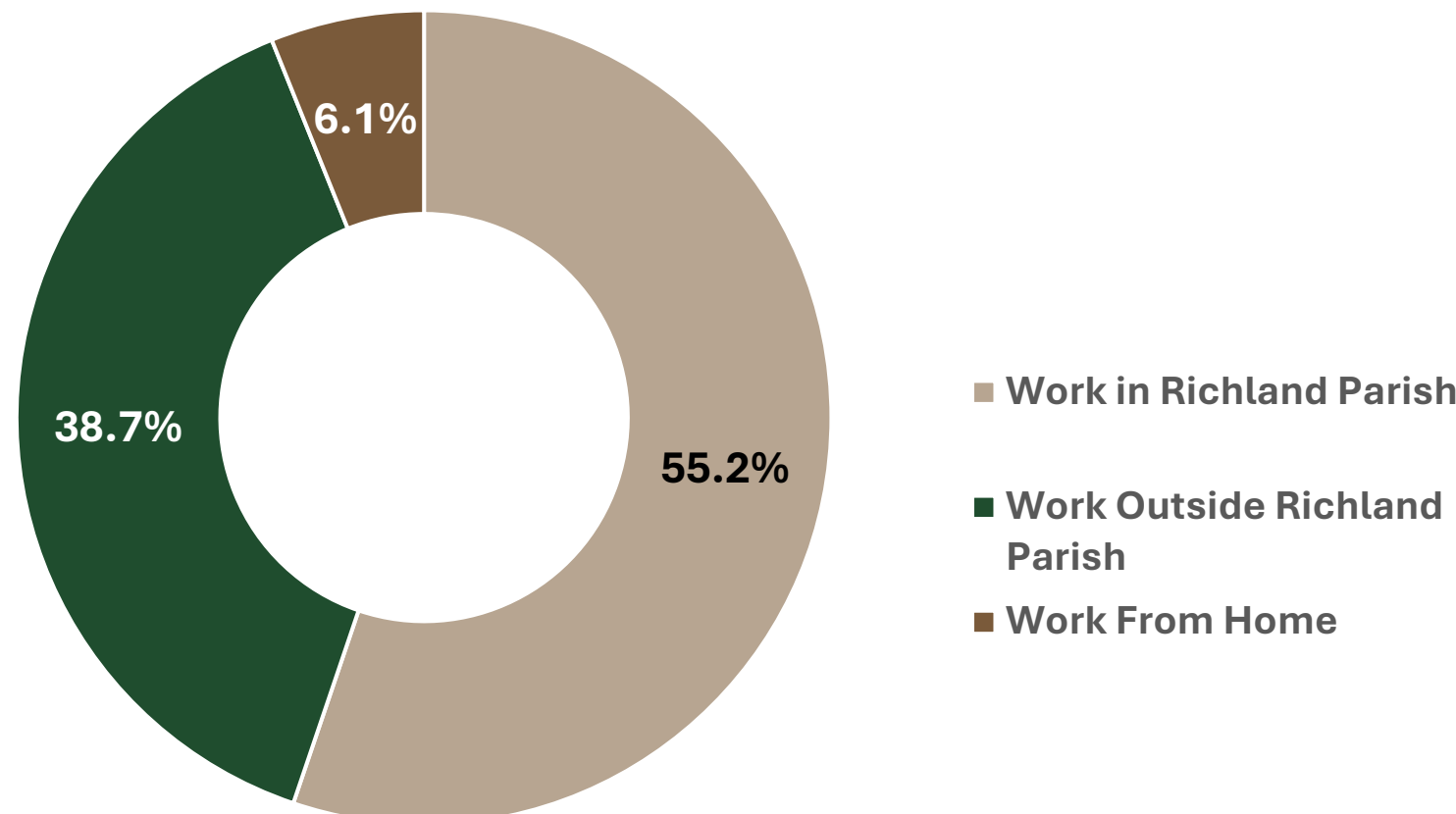
- The median age is 40.1 years.
- Richland Parish has an older population than the state average, with many residents between ages 45 and 74.

EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT



- More than 80% of adults have a high school diploma or higher.
- Nearly 18% of adults hold a bachelor's degree or advanced degree.

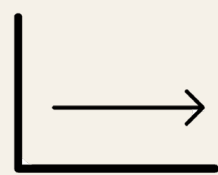
WORKFORCE COMMUTING PATTERNS



- Nearly 4 in 10 workers commute outside the parish for employment opportunities.
- More than half of employed residents both live and work within Richland Parish.

KEY DEMOGRAPHIC FINDINGS

Steady as We Go



Population growth has remained relatively stable over the last three decades and is expected to remain steady in the near term.

Plan Focus: Invest in quality of life and strengthen existing communities rather than planning for rapid growth.

A Community in Its Prime



The Parish has a mature population, with strong representation across working-age and retirement-age residents.

Plan Focus: Prioritize gathering spaces, accessibility, recreation, and services that support adults and older residents.

A Strong Foundation



Most residents have completed high school, providing a solid base for workforce and economic development.

Plan Focus: Support workforce training, business growth, and local job opportunities.

Connected Beyond Parish Lines



Many residents commute outside the Parish for work, while others both live and work locally.

Plan Focus: Strengthen local employment opportunities and reduce commuter outflow.

\$54K
Median Income
Below Louisiana's median of ~\$61K

22%
Poverty Rate
Above Louisiana's rate of ~14%

51.5%
Labor Force Participation
Below Louisiana's rate of ~58%

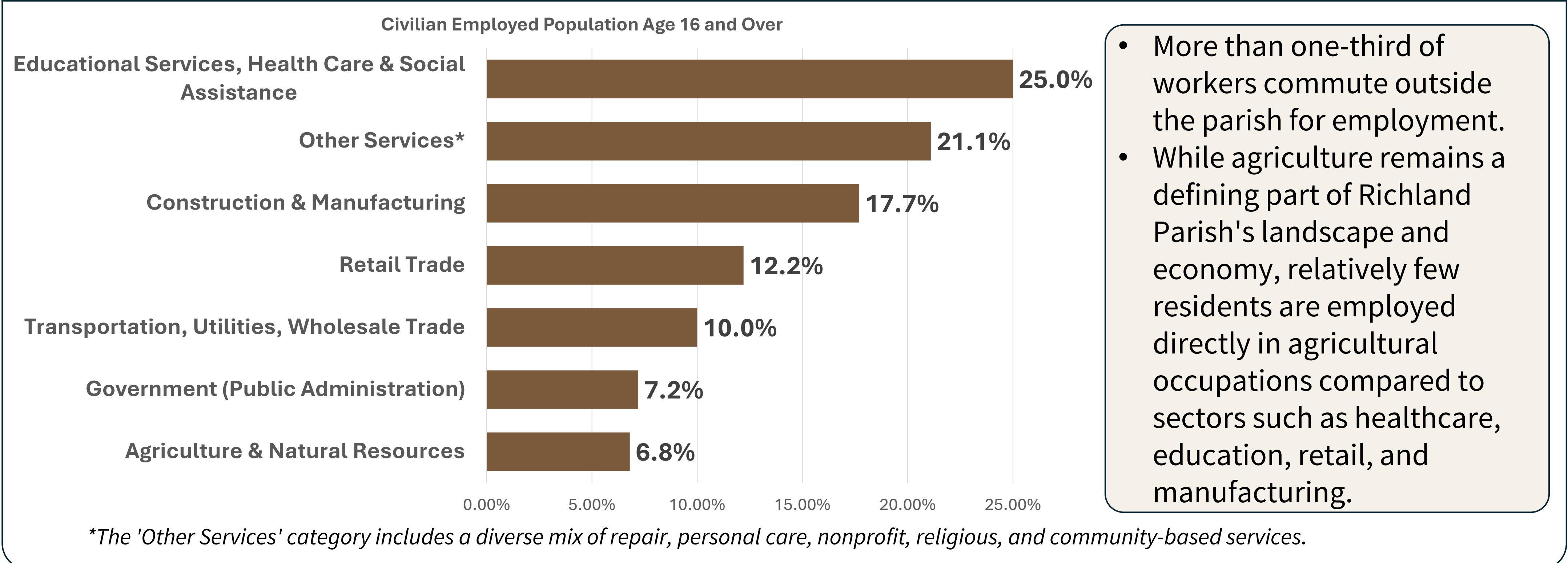
8.9%
Unemployment Rate
Above Louisiana's rate of ~6%

\$29K
Per Capita Income
Below Louisiana's average of ~\$36K

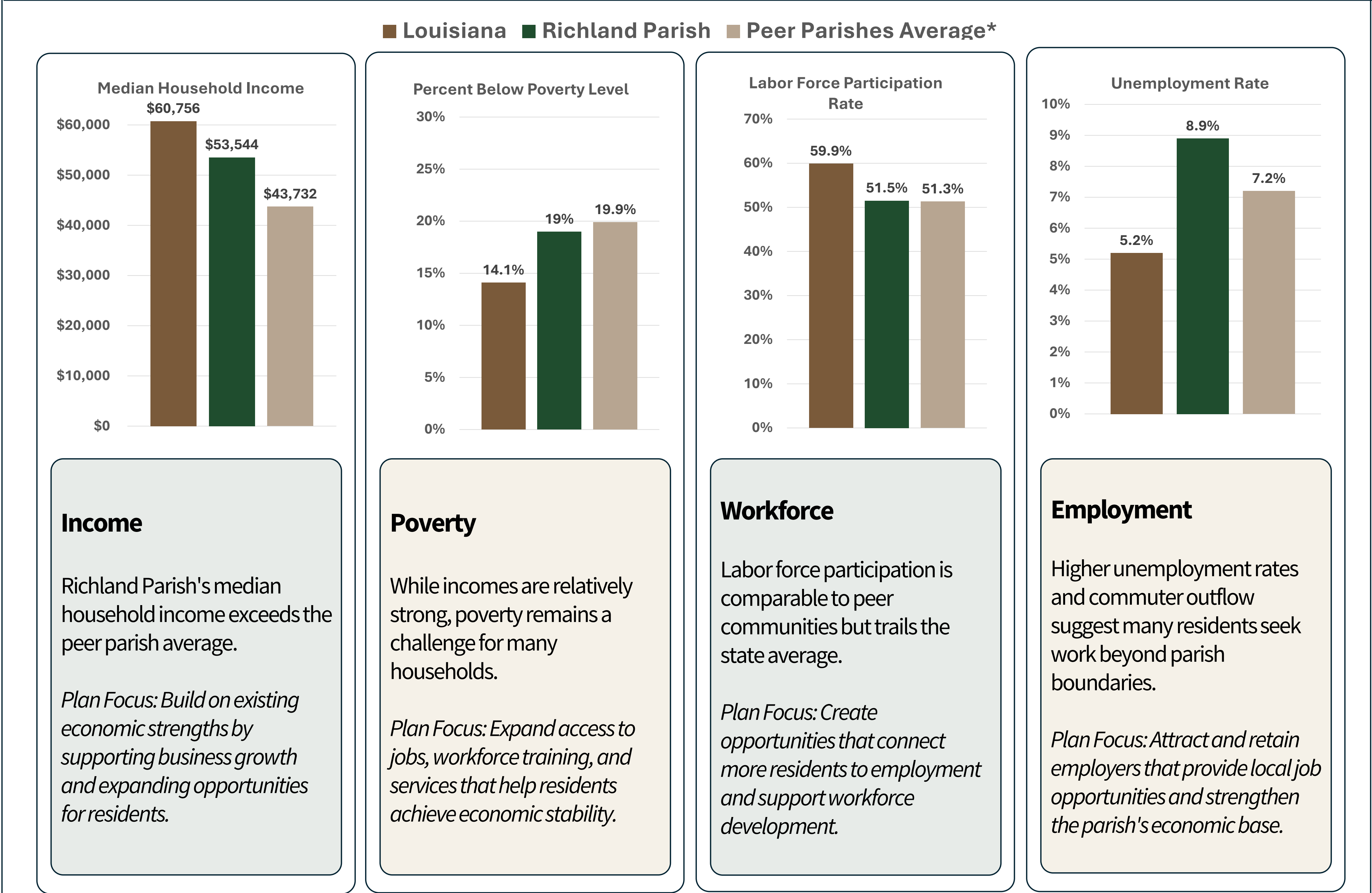
A strong economy supports quality jobs, local businesses, and long-term community prosperity. Understanding how residents earn a living, where they work, and the economic opportunities and challenges facing the parish helps inform recommendations for economic development, workforce growth, and future investment.

As you review the information below, consider how these trends should influence future business attraction efforts, workforce initiatives, infrastructure investments, and economic development priorities.

EMPLOYMENT BY INDUSTRY SECTOR



ECONOMIC INDICATORS COMPARISON



*Peer Parishes include Caldwell, East Carroll, Franklin, Madison, Morehouse, Ouachita, and West Carroll Parishes.

Help Us Tell Richland’s Story

How has Richland Parish changed over the last 10 years, and where should it be headed in the future?

- Use the sticky notes provided to share:
- What Richland was like in 2016
 - What Richland is like today
 - What you hope Richland will be like in 2036

Write one idea per note and place it in the appropriate column.

THEN (2016)	NOW (2026)	NEXT (2036)

Understanding how land is used today helps establish a baseline for future planning decisions. The map and data shown here are based on land use classifications developed from existing Parish Assessor property tax categories. These classifications help us understand where agricultural, residential, commercial, and industrial activity exists today. As the planning process moves forward, this information will help the Parish and residents evaluate how and where future growth should occur.

KEY TERMS

Existing Land Use

How land is currently being used today, based on property characteristics and existing Parish Assessor classifications.

Existing Development Pattern

The current distribution of agricultural, residential, commercial, industrial, and public land uses across the Parish.

Future Land Use

A community vision that identifies where future growth, development, investment, and conservation should occur over time.

HOW TODAY'S LAND USE INFORMATION BECOMES TOMORROW'S PLAN

1 Existing Land Use

Current Parish Assessor land use categories are grouped into six simple land use classifications to help understand how land is used today.

2 Develop Zoning Classifications

The Parish will work with the project team to develop zoning classifications that help guide future growth and development.

3 Create an Existing Zoning Map

Existing land uses will be categorized into zoning classifications that reflect current development patterns throughout the parish.

4 Develop a Future Land Use Map

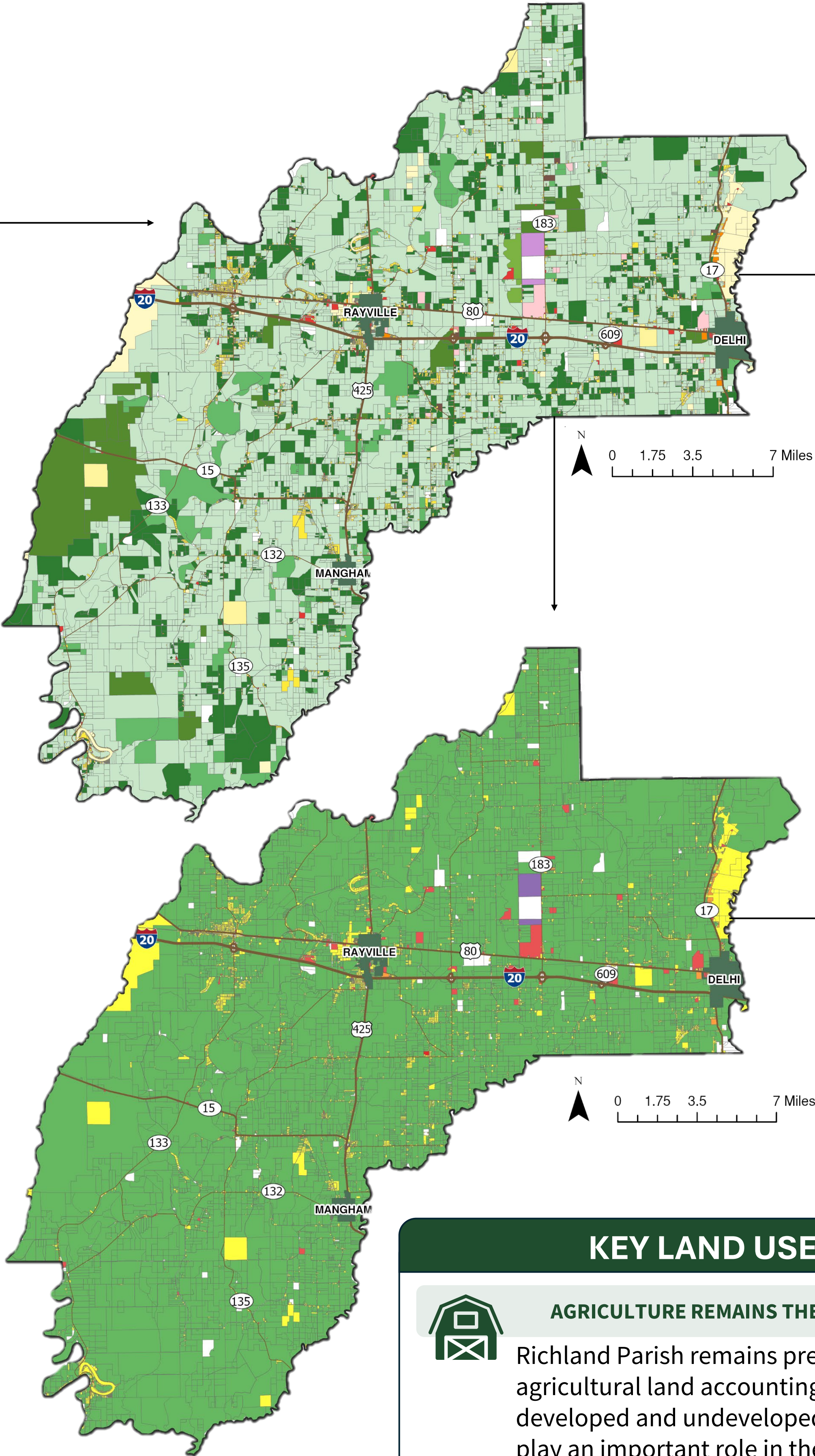
A Future Land Use Map identifies the community's long-term vision for growth and development. It does not regulate property, but serves as a guide for future decisions.

5 Community Input Shapes the Future

Public input collected over the next several months will help guide future land use recommendations and development priorities.

6 Adoption & Implementation

The Parish will formally adopt the Master Plan and Development Code, creating a framework to guide future growth and development decisions.



ASSESSOR LAND USE CLASSIFICATIONS	
	Municipalities Not Included in the Plan
	Not Classified
	Agricultural Improved (AI)
	Agri. Use Misc. Improvements (AM)
	Agricultural Use Vacant (AV)
	Commercial/Agricultural (CA)
	Commercial/Agri. Improvements (CG)
	Commercial Improvements (CI)
	Commercial Misc. Imps. (CM)
	Commercial Vacant (CV)
	Commercial/Residential (CR)
	Commercial Transitional (CT)
	Exempt Government (EG)
	Exempt Religious (ER)
	Exempt (EX)
	Industrial/Agricultural (IA)
	Industrial Vacant (IV)
	Mobile Home Park (CP)
	Mobile Home (MH)
	Residential Building Only (RB)
	Residential Improvements (RI)
	Residential Misc. Improvements (RM)
	Residential Vacant (RV)

CONSOLIDATED LAND USE CLASSIFICATIONS	
	Municipalities Not Included in the Plan
	Not Classified
	Agricultural (AG)
	Commercial (CM)
	Industrial (IN)
	Mixed Use (MU)
	Single-Family Residential (SF)

Land Use	Acres	% of Total Acres
Agricultural (AG)	337,903	93.6%
Single-Family (SF)	6,902	1.9%
Unclassified (Rights of Way)	6,630	1.8%
Heavy Industrial (HI)	5,684	1.6%
Incorporated Areas	3,431	0.9%
Commercial (CM)	323	0.1%
Light Industrial (LI)	189	<0.1%
Mixed Use (MU)	121	<0.1%
Total	361,184	100%

KEY LAND USE FINDINGS



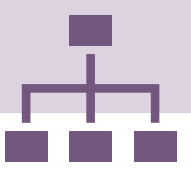
AGRICULTURE REMAINS THE DOMINANT LAND USE

Richland Parish remains predominantly rural, with agricultural land accounting for the largest share of developed and undeveloped land. Agriculture continues to play an important role in the Parish's economy, character, and landscape.



GROWTH IS CONCENTRATED AROUND COMMUNITIES

Residential, commercial, and public development is generally concentrated near towns, transportation corridors, and employment centers, helping support efficient access to services and infrastructure.



FUTURE GROWTH REQUIRES COORDINATION

Future land use decisions help guide where housing, businesses, industry, and public facilities are encouraged, while zoning districts and development standards help shape how that growth occurs.

AGRICULTURAL

Preserve farmland and open space.



FUTURE LAND USE EXERCISE

Where should future housing, businesses, industry, and farmland be located as Richland Parish grows over the next 20 years?

PLACE A STICKER ON THE MAP TO SHOW WHERE YOU THINK EACH TYPE OF DEVELOPMENT BELONGS.

AGRICULTURAL

RESIDENTIAL

COMMERCIAL

INDUSTRIAL

RESIDENTIAL

New neighborhoods and housing options



COMMERCIAL

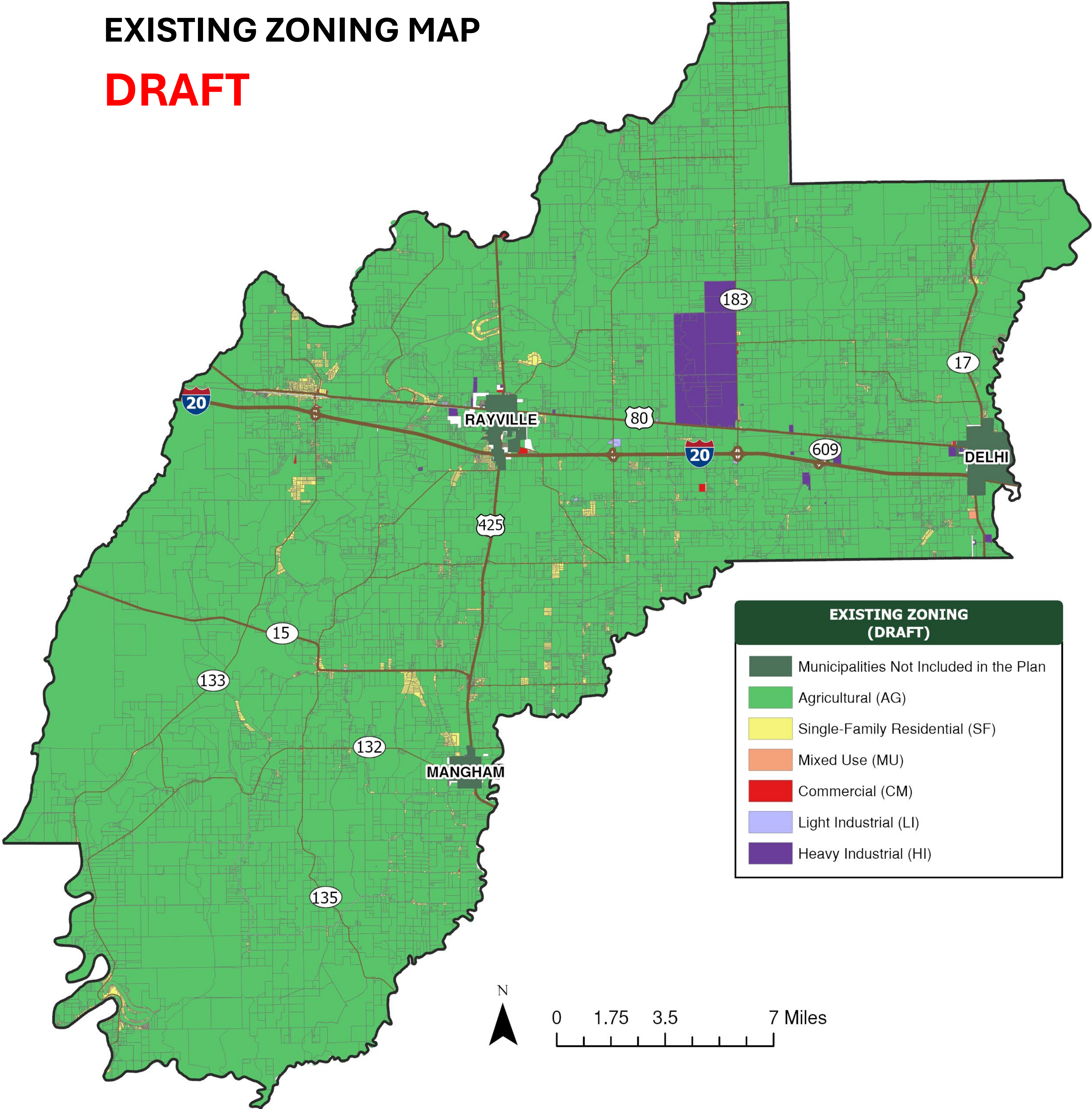
Stores, restaurants, and services.



INDUSTRIAL

Manufacturing, logistics, and jobs.





TELL US WHY!

What matters most to you when thinking about future land use?



PLEASE USE STICKY NOTES TO TELL US MORE!



Economic Opportunities



More Housing Choices



Protect Rural Character



More Services & Shopping



More Jobs



Other (Write in)

Homeownership Rate

80.9%



Owner-occupied households

Vacancy Rate

17.1%



1,494 vacant out of 8,734 total housing units

Median Home Value

\$168,800



Owner-occupied housing with a mortgage

Median Monthly Rent

\$903



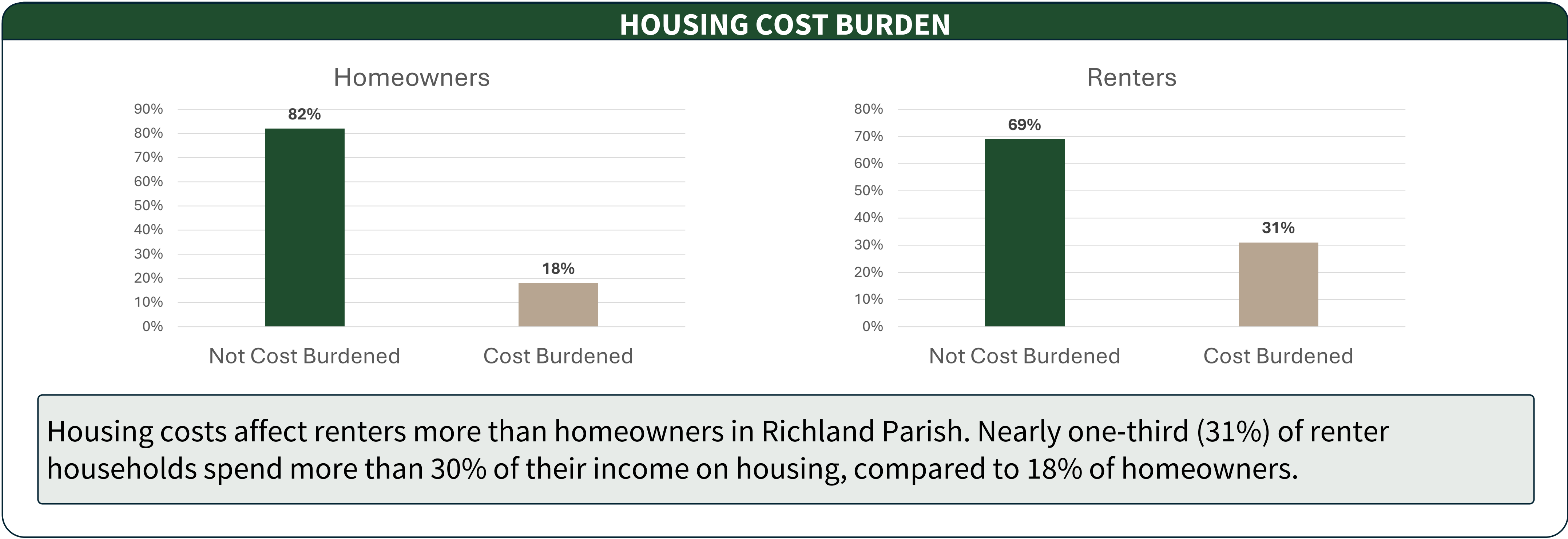
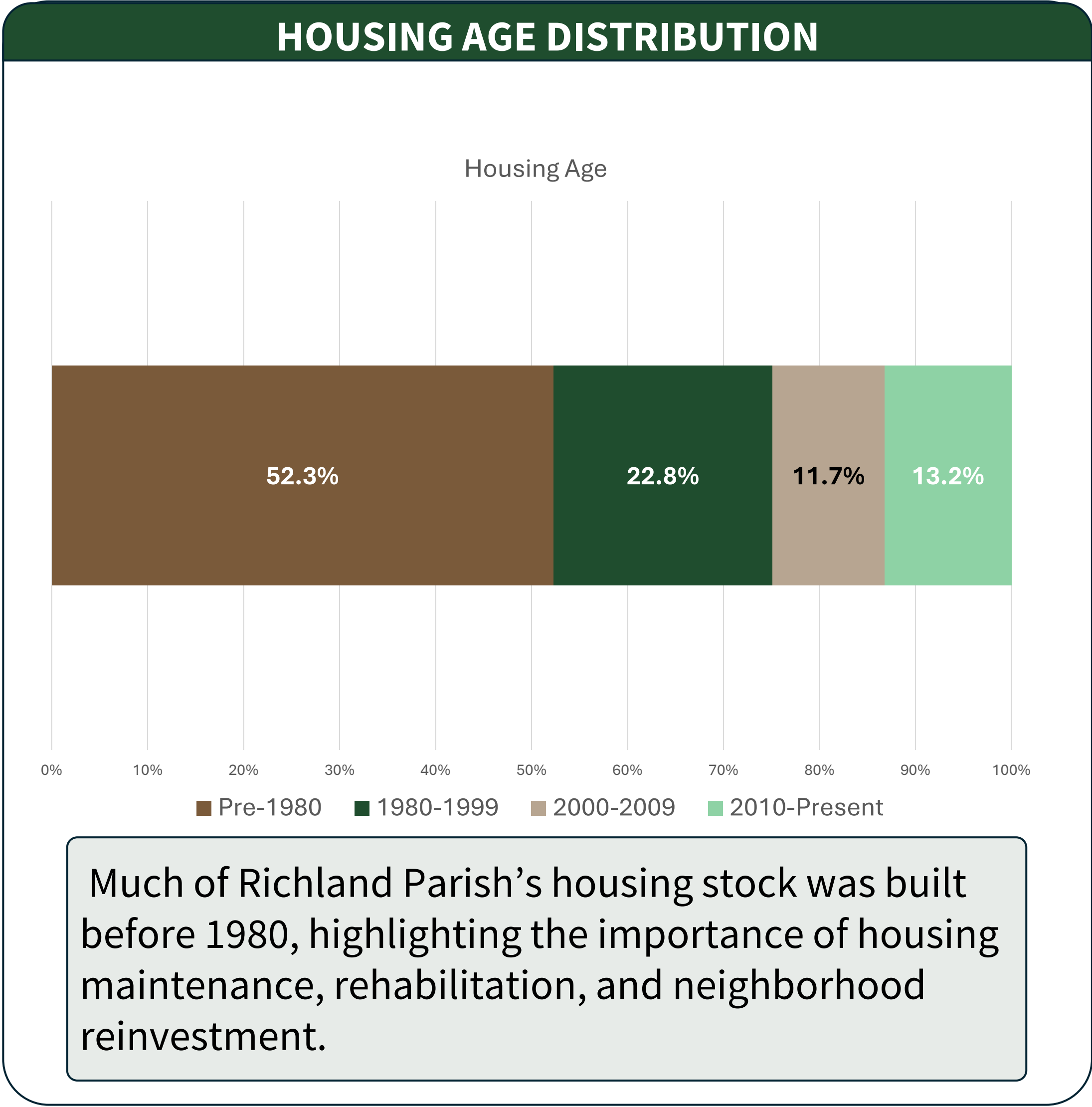
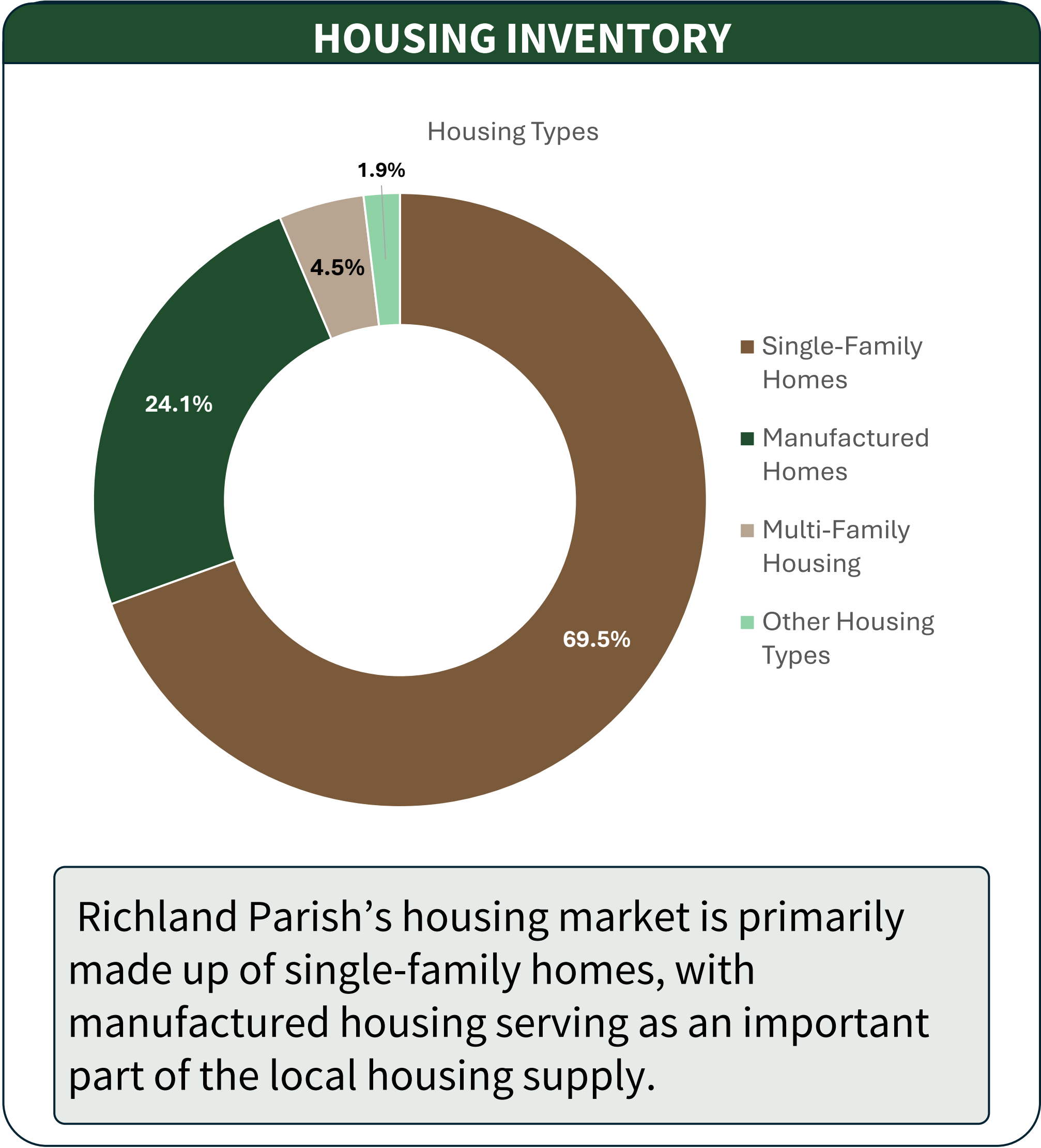
Median gross rent for renter-occupied housing

Housing Cost Burden

18% Owners
31% Renters



Federal standard: spend less than 30% of income on housing





Aging Housing Stock

Richland Parish's housing stock is relatively mature, with more than half (52.3%) of all housing units built before 1980. Older housing can offer affordability and neighborhood character, but it may also require ongoing maintenance, rehabilitation, and infrastructure upgrades to remain safe, attractive, and competitive for future residents.

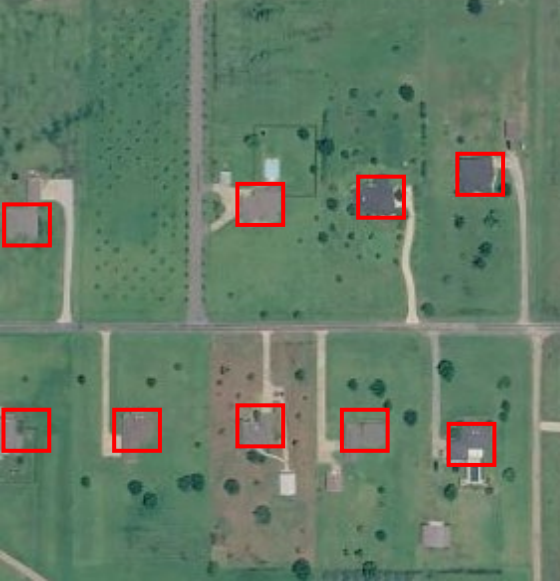
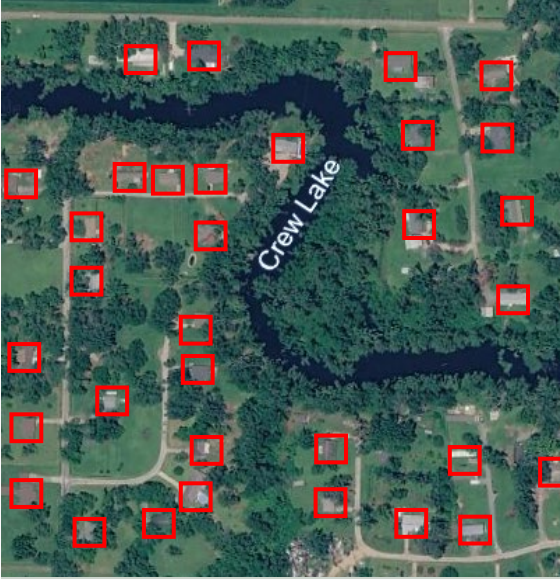


Transportation Access & Household Mobility

Approximately 8.7% of households in Richland Parish do not have access to a vehicle. In a rural community where most destinations require driving, households without a vehicle may face greater challenges accessing employment, healthcare, education, shopping, and other essential services. This highlights the importance of considering transportation access alongside future housing and community development decisions.

What types of housing would you like to see in Richland Parish?

Place up to three stickers on the housing types you would most like to see in Richland Parish over the next 20 years.

Housing Types	Description	Example		Vote
Agricultural/ Rural Residential	Agricultural/rural residential housing is low density residential on half-acre lots or greater, typically in an agricultural setting.			
Low Density Single Family Detached	This housing type refers to a building designed for and occupied by one family on an acre lot, or greater.			
Medium Density Single Family Detached	This housing type refers to a building designed for and occupied by one family on a half-acre lot, or greater.			
High Density Single Family Detached (Garden Homes)	Garden homes are a single family detached housing type, typically on a smaller lot than a traditional suburban single detached home.			
Single Family Attached	A residential dwelling unit that shares one or more common walls with adjacent units, typically in the form of townhouses, condominiums, or row houses.			
Mobile Home Park	Manufactured homes are built in a manufacturing plant and transported on a permanent chassis. This housing type can be placed in individual lots or in subdivision development lots.			
Multi-Family	Multi-family dwellings may include both low-rise and high-rise buildings designed for high- density residential use.			
Mixed-Use	Mixed-Use refers to single-family attached or multi-family housing in densely developed areas that support the integration of residential and commercial uses.			

CORRIDORS DRIVE OUR
COMMUNITY

Major highways connect residents to jobs, schools, services, and opportunities.



TRAFFIC VOLUMES GUIDE
INVESTMENT

Understanding where traffic is highest helps prioritize future transportation needs.



SAFETY & RELIABILITY
MATTER

A strong roadway network supports safer travel and emergency response.



PLAN TODAY FOR
TOMORROW

Thoughtful planning ensures our transportation system supports future growth.



FUNCTIONAL ROADWAY SYSTEM

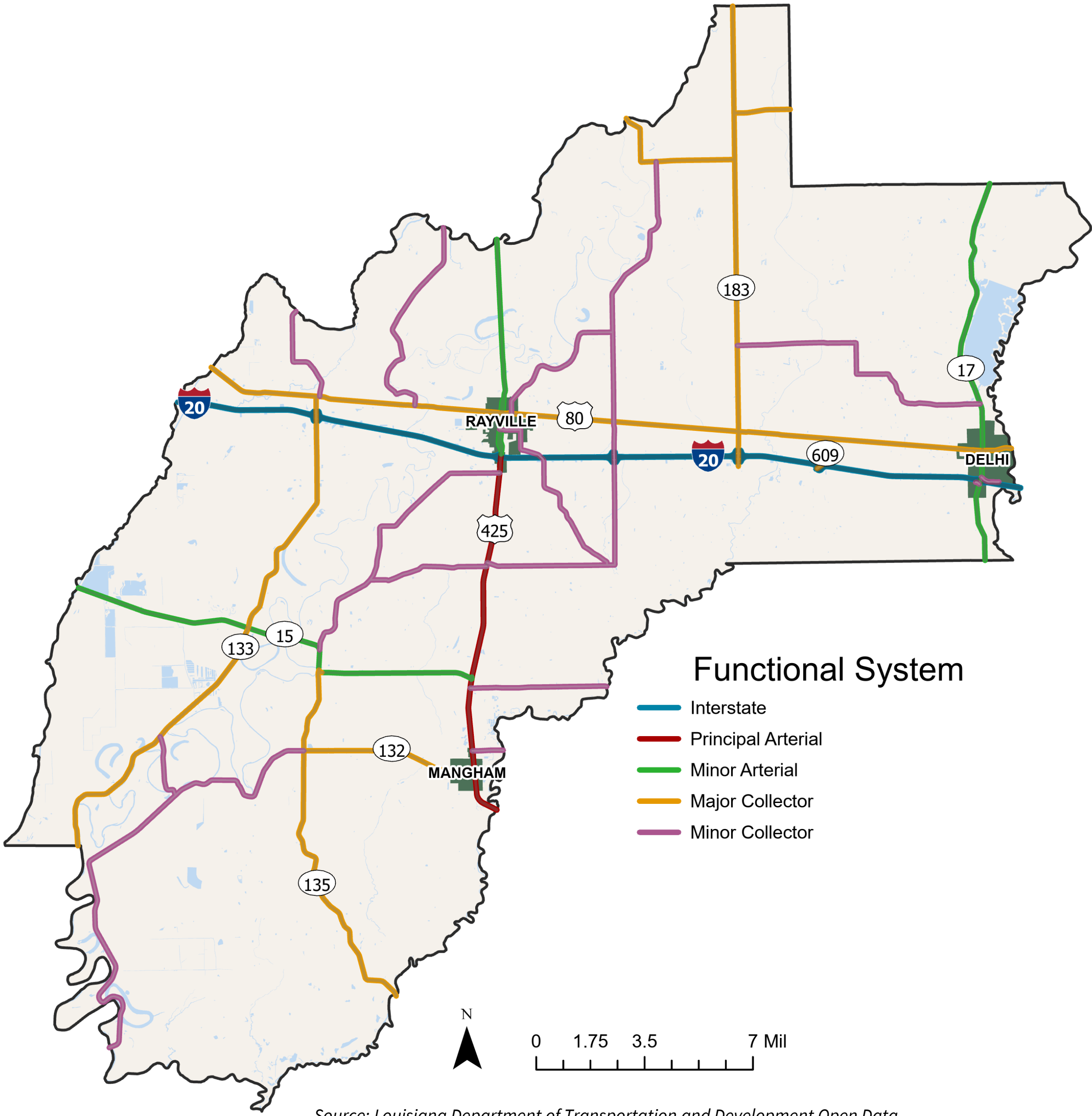
Interstate – corridors of national importance that provide long distance travel

Principal Arterial – corridors of regional importance that connect large activity centers

Minor Arterial – corridors of local importance that connect activity centers

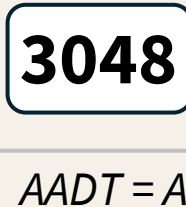
Major Collector– roadways that provide connections between arterials and to other local roads and streets

Minor Collector– roadways that provide connections between major collectors to other local roads and streets



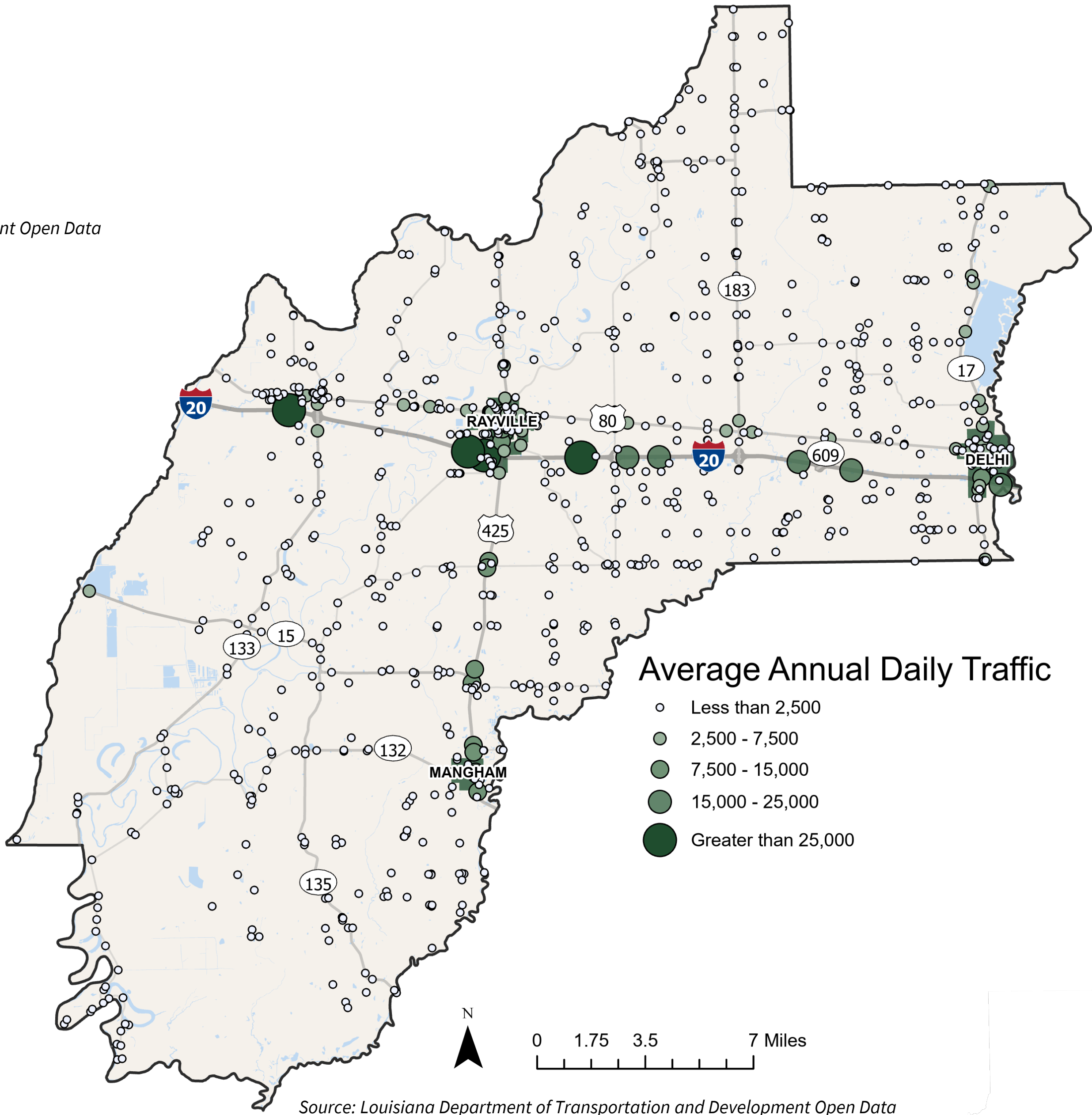
Source: Louisiana Department of Transportation and Development Open Data

HIGHEST TRAFFIC HIGHWAYS

ROADWAY	AADT
 I-20	35,646
 US 425	15,444
 US 80	8,119
 LA 3048	2,942

AADT = Average Annual Daily Traffic

Average Annual Daily Traffic (AADT)
– the total volume of traffic on a specific section of a road or highway for a full year divided by 365 days



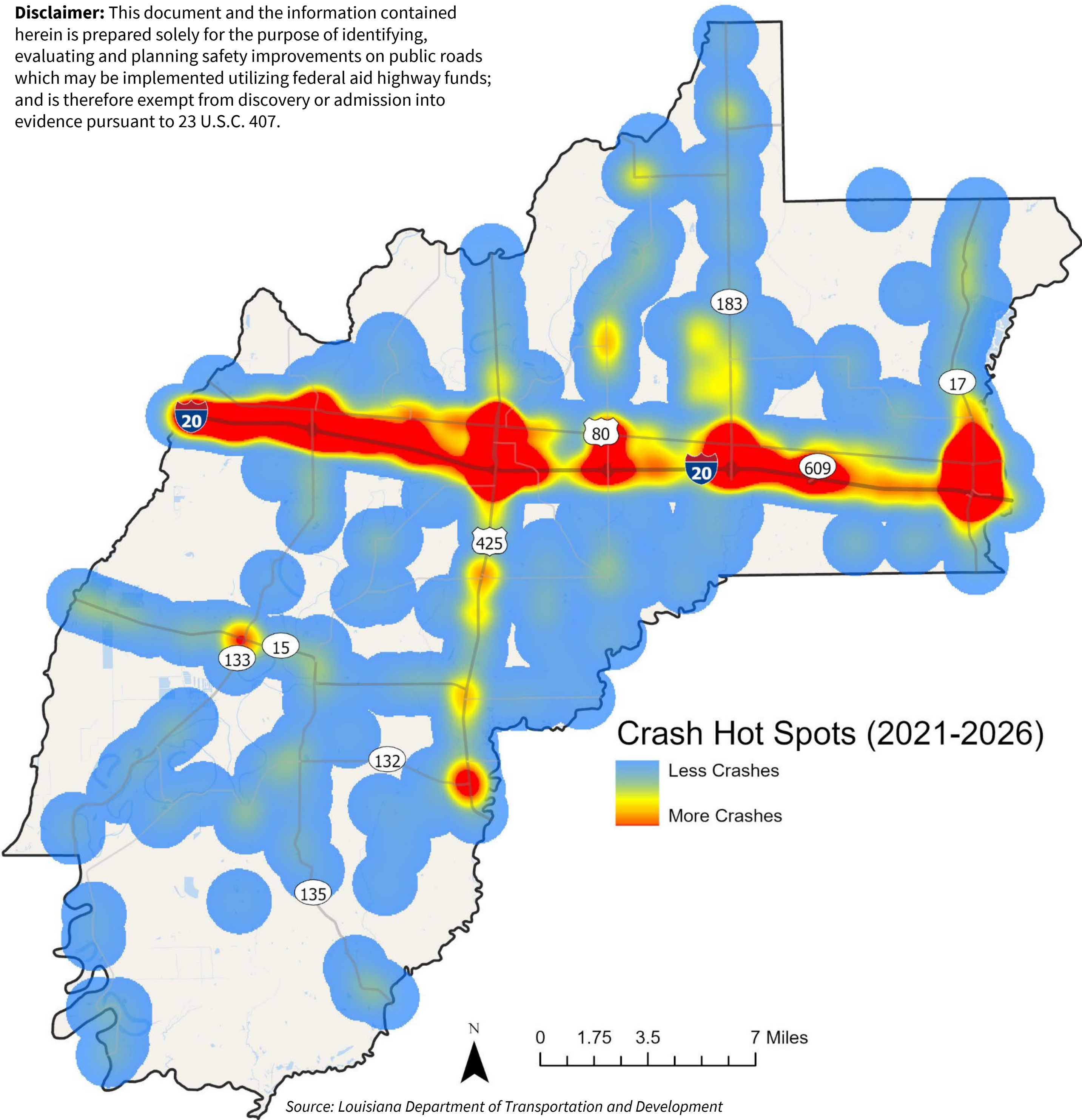
Source: Louisiana Department of Transportation and Development Open Data

UNDERSTANDING TRANSPORTATION & MOBILITY

Understanding the existing conditions of the Richland Parish transportation system as well as traffic patterns helps to provide a baseline of the strengths, deficiencies and needs of the system that will inform the Richland Parish Master Plan.

This data and your input ensures that future investments are responsive to existing conditions while also preparing Richland Parish for future growth and travel demand

Disclaimer: This document and the information contained herein is prepared solely for the purpose of identifying, evaluating and planning safety improvements on public roads which may be implemented utilizing federal aid highway funds; and is therefore exempt from discovery or admission into evidence pursuant to 23 U.S.C. 407.



KEY TRANSPORTATION FINDINGS



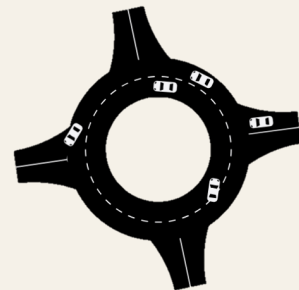
Regional Connectivity

Interstate 20 serves as Richland Parish’s primary transportation corridor, connecting local communities to regional employment, goods movement, and services.



Traffic Concentration

The highest traffic volumes are concentrated along the I-20 corridor and US 80, highlighting these routes as critical corridors for mobility and economic activity.



Safety Challenges

Crash hot spots are concentrated around major highway intersections and along high-volume roadways, indicating locations where safety improvements may be needed. Total number of crashes and severe crashes has increased over the past 2 years

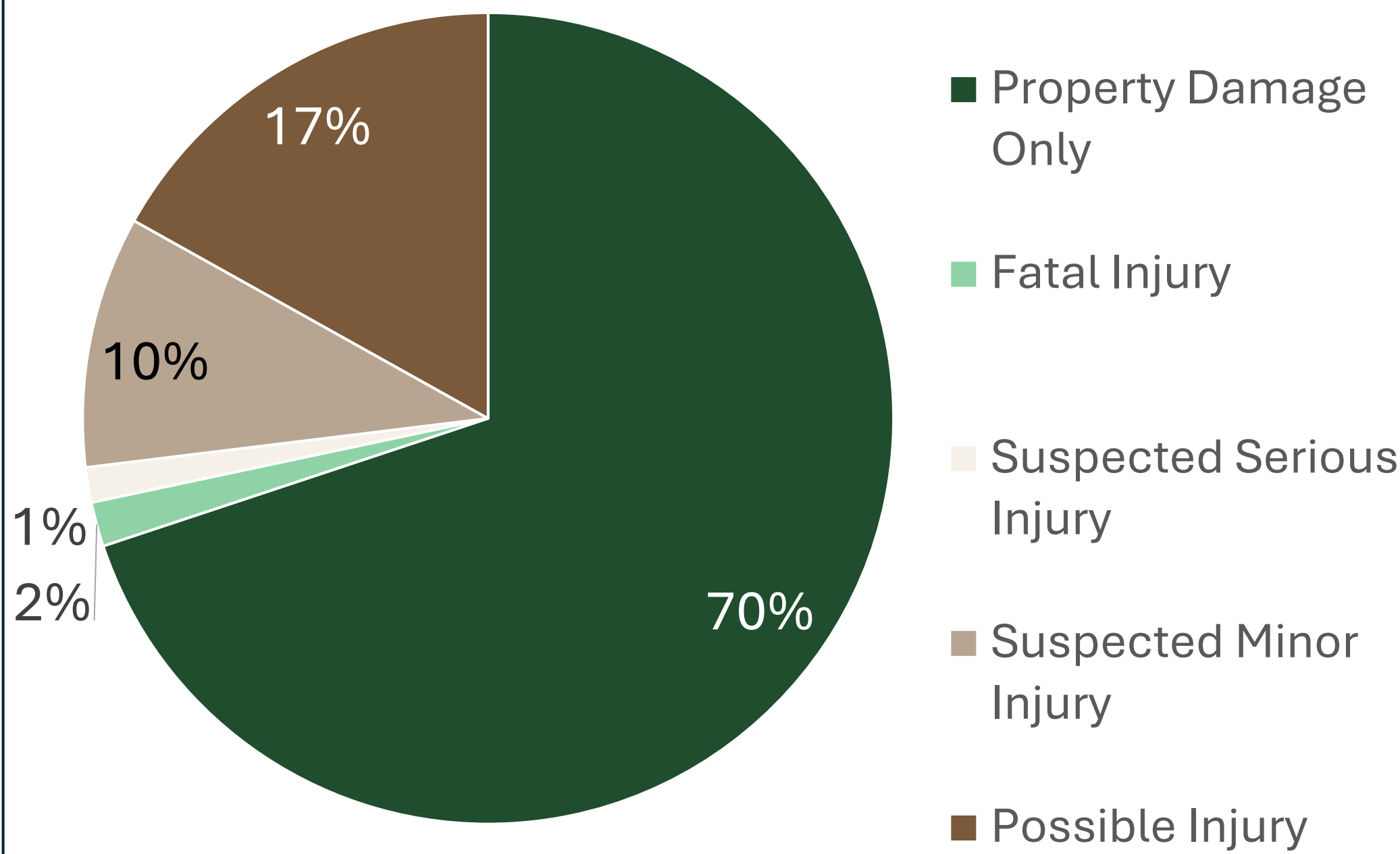


Limited Transportation Options

Most residents rely on personal vehicles for daily travel. Expanding transportation choices and improving connectivity can support access to jobs, services, and community destinations.

CRASH TRENDS

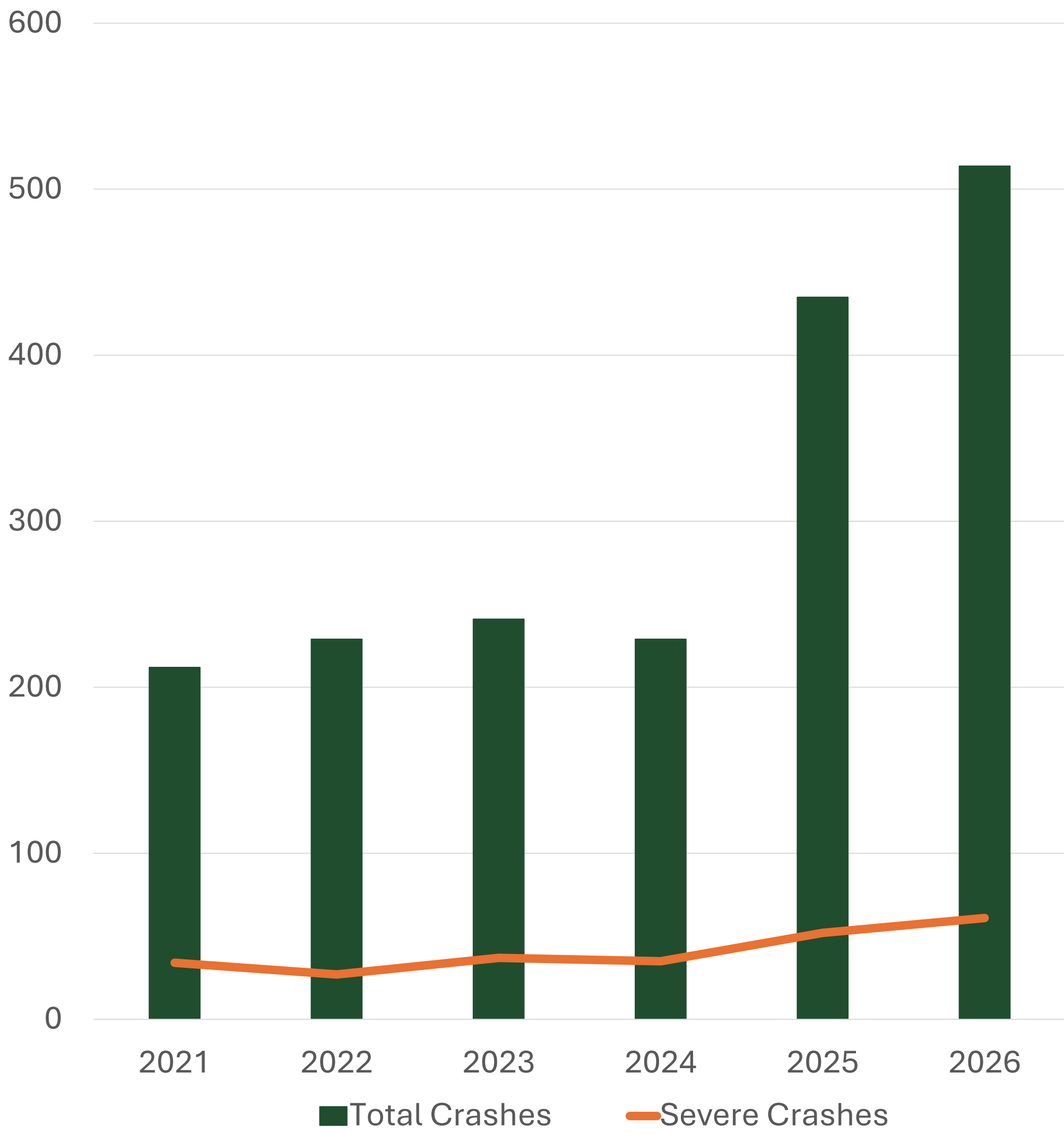
Crash Severity



- Most crashes (70%) result in property damage only, with no reported injuries.
- While severe crashes are less common, reducing fatal and serious injury crashes remains a transportation priority.

CRASH TRENDS

Number of Crashes and Severe Crashes (2021 - 2026)



POTENTIAL TRANSPORTATION PRIORITIES

Preserve Roadway

Infrastructure through maintenance and repair of existing network.

Improve Safety on key corridors and intersections through improved design and roadway visibility

Enhance I-20 by prioritizing improvements to help traffic flow and support freight movement

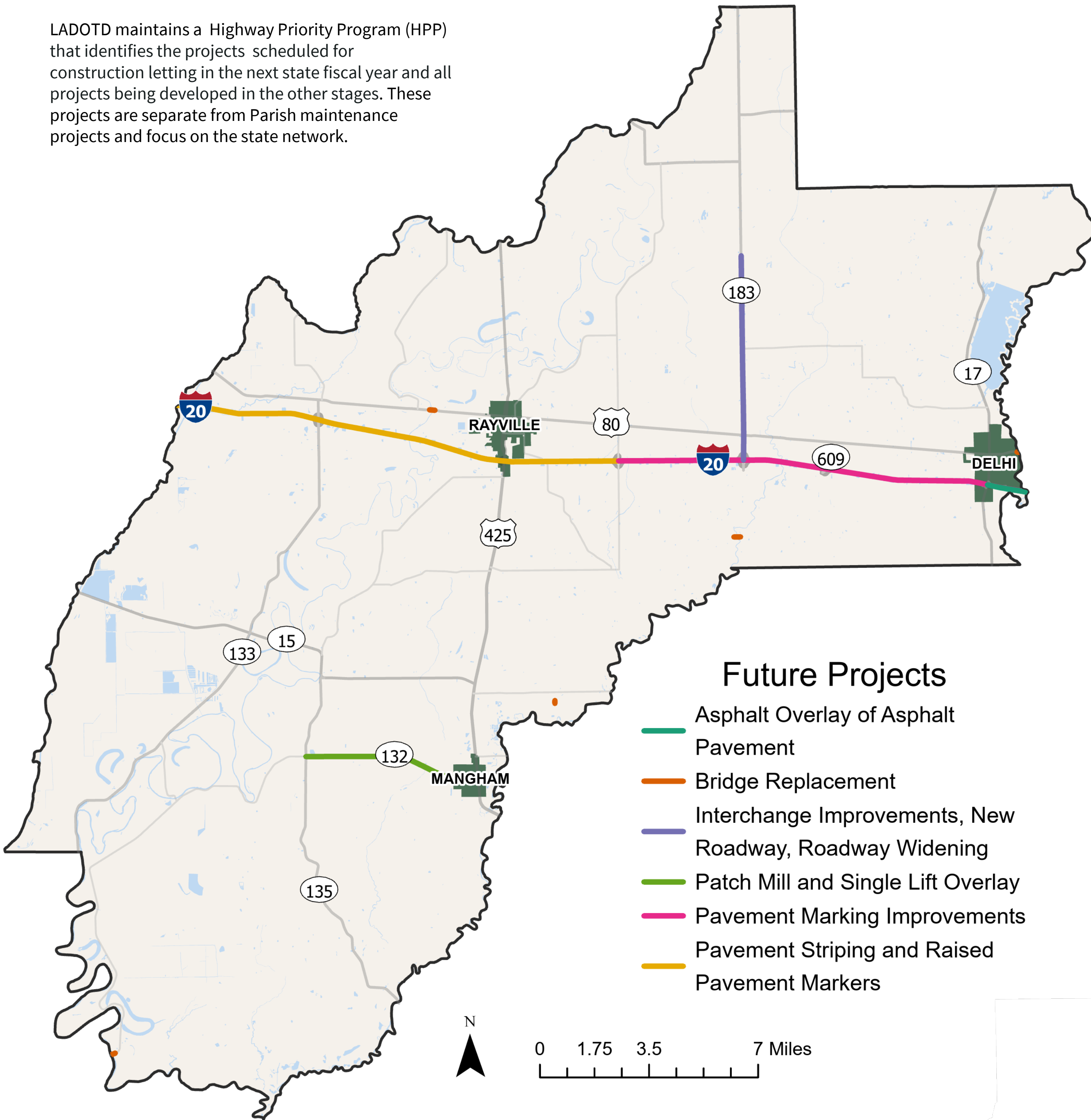
Improve Community Connectivity by creating a more comprehensive roadway network

Replace & Repair Bridges to improve reliability of critical crossings

Pedestrian and Bicycle Improvements that would create a more diverse transportation network

What other transportation priorities would you like to see in Richland Parish?

LADOTD maintains a Highway Priority Program (HPP) that identifies the projects scheduled for construction letting in the next state fiscal year and all projects being developed in the other stages. These projects are separate from Parish maintenance projects and focus on the state network.



Source: Louisiana Department of Transportation & Development (LADOTD) Highway Priority Program

TRANSPORTATION PRIORITIES EXERCISE

Which transportation investments are most important to you?

INSTRUCTIONS: Place three stickers beside the transportation improvements that would have the greatest impact on you, your family, or your community.

MAINTAIN EXISTING ROADS

- Preserve pavement conditions
- Repair deteriorating roadways
- Extend roadway life

☐☐☐

IMPROVE ROADWAY SAFETY

- Address dangerous intersections
- Reduce crashes
- Improve pavement markings and signage

☐☐☐

ENHANCE THE I-20 CORRIDOR

- Improve traffic flow
- Support freight movement
- Strengthen regional access

☐☐☐

IMPROVE COMMUNITY CONNECTIVITY

- Strengthen connections between communities
- Improve access to schools, jobs, and services
- Enhance local travel routes

☐☐☐

REPLACE & REPAIR BRIDGES

- Maintain critical crossings
- Improve reliability
- Address aging infrastructure

☐☐☐

WALKING & BIKING IMPROVEMENTS

- Sidewalks
- Trails
- Safer crossings

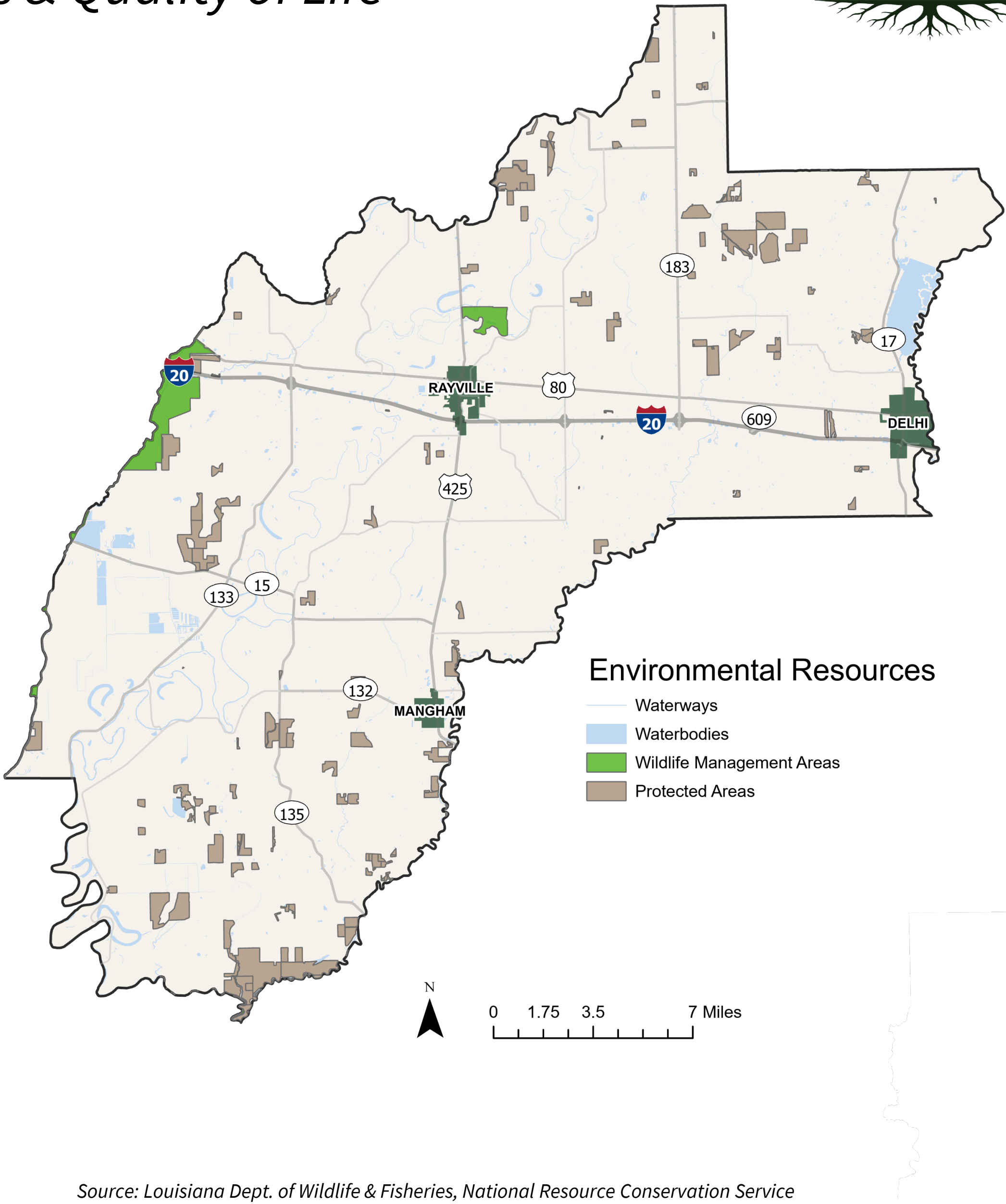
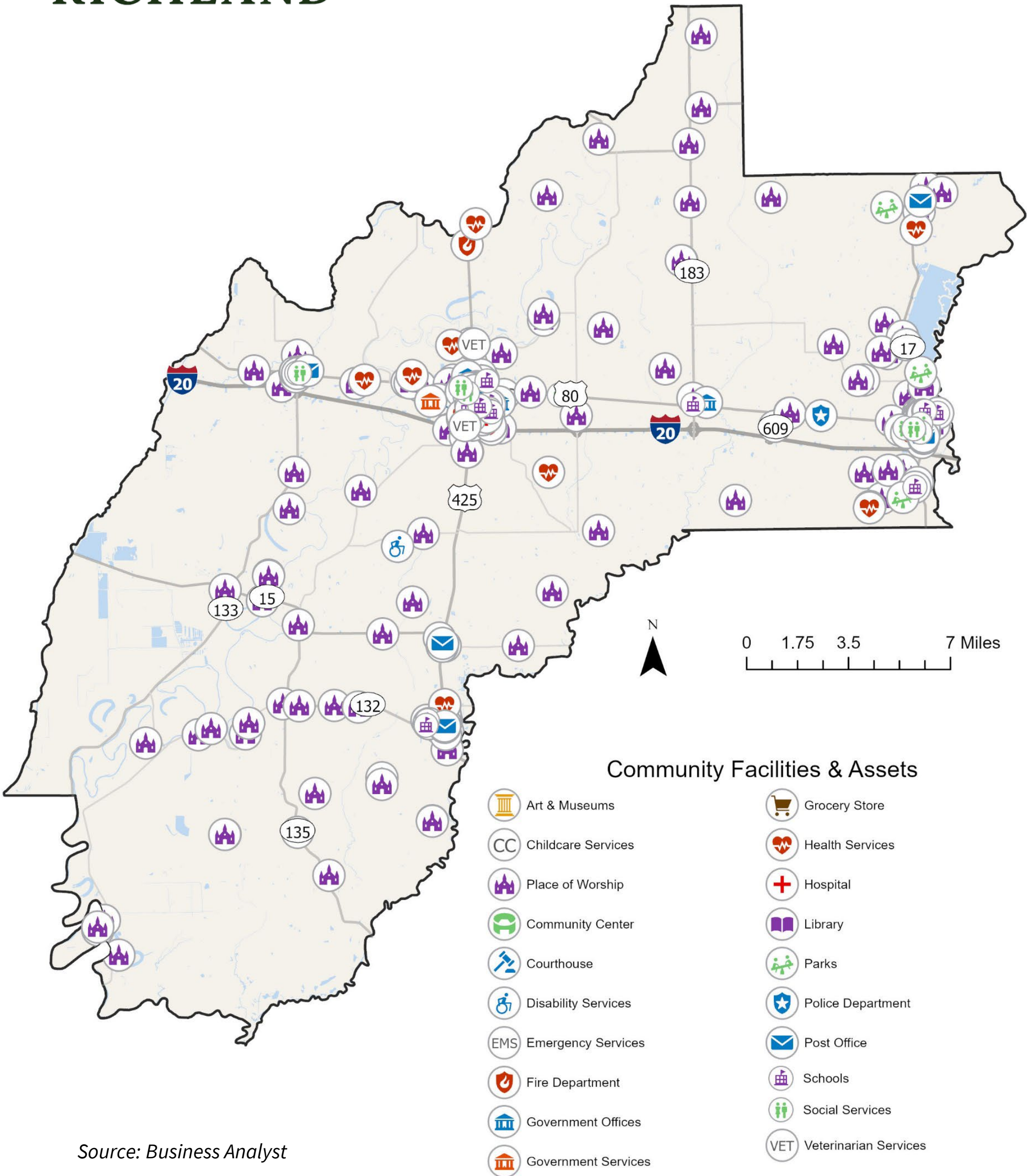
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OTHER

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What Makes Richland Parish Unique?

Community Assets & Quality of Life



PARISH HIGHLIGHTS



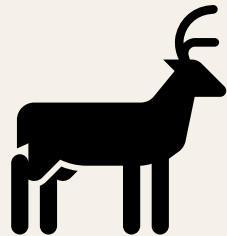
Community

Richland Parish contains a variety of community assets and services as well as over **400** businesses.



Agriculture

Richland Parish supports a strong agricultural industry with the top agricultural crops by acreage being corn, soybeans, cotton, and rice. Totalling over **250,000** acres across the Parish.



Wildlife

Richland Parish is dedicated to the conservation of fish, wildlife, and their habitats and supports **3,500** acres of wildlife management areas.



Natural Resources

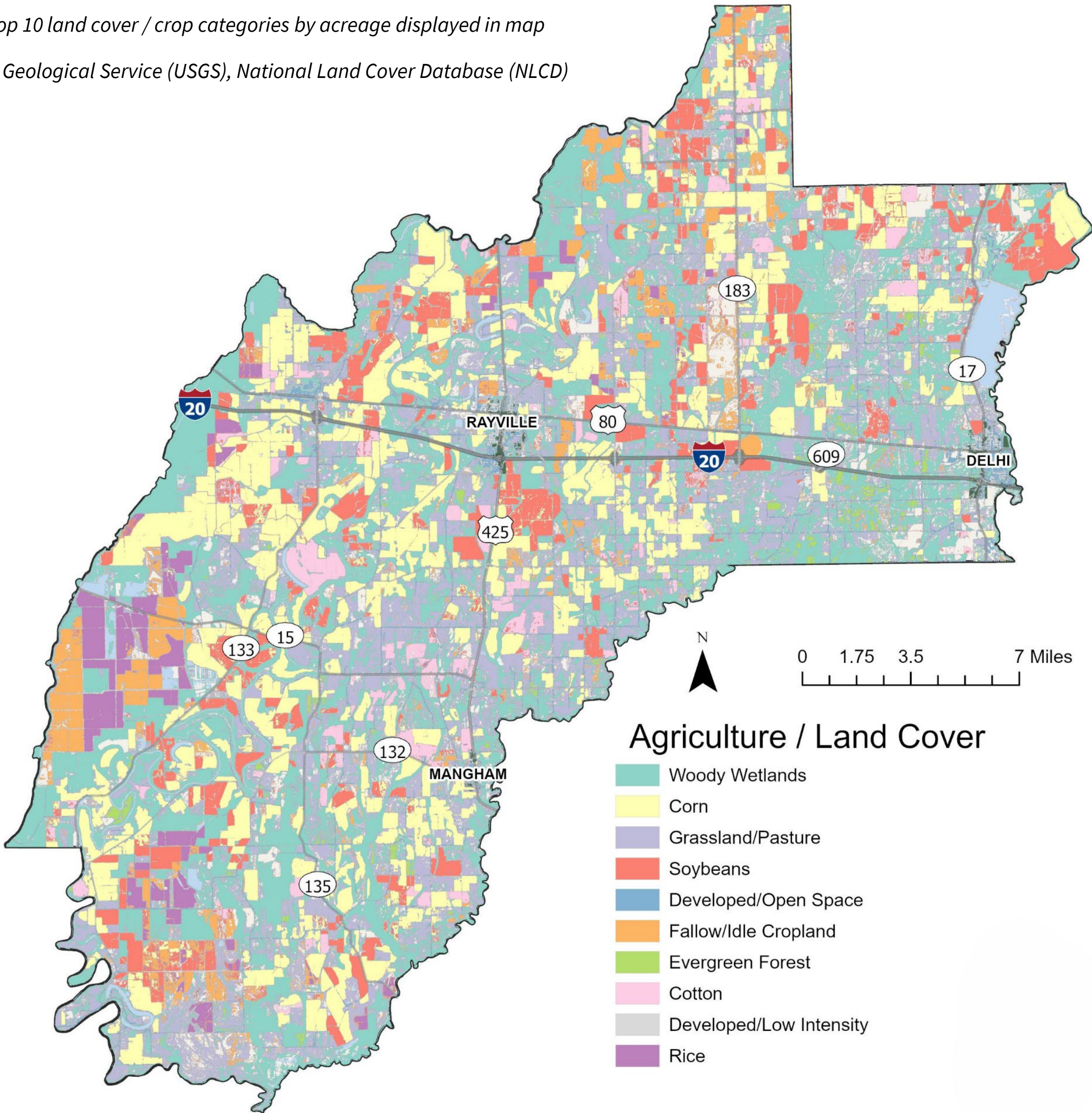
Richland Parish values the surrounding natural environment and its preservation with over **14,000** acres of conservation easements.

These foundational elements help shape the identity, economy, and quality of life of Richland Parish. Evaluating these resources will help identify opportunities for economic development, preserve critical natural resources, and strengthen connections between residents and essential services. Understanding the role of these assets ensures that the Richland Parish Master Plan balances growth with the protection and enhancement of Richland Parish's unique roots, character, and resources.

Rank	Land Cover / Crop Category	Total Acreage in Parish	Percent of Parish Land Cover
1	Wooded Wetlands	240,742	30.5%
2	Corn	155,838	19.8%
3	Grassland / Pasture	113,885	14.4%
4	Soybeans	69,983	8.9%
5	Developed / Open Space	30,639	3.9%
6	Fallow / Idle Cropland	28,885	3.7%
7	Evergreen Forest	20,986	2.7%
8	Cotton	17,190	2.2%
9	Developed / Low Intensity	13,926	1.8%
10	Rice	12,206	1.5%

Note: Only top 10 land cover / crop categories by acreage displayed in map

Source: U.S. Geological Service (USGS), National Land Cover Database (NLCD)



Instructions:

What challenges do you see today? What ideas could improve Richland Parish in the Future?
Place your sticky note in the appropriate category.

Big Idea

If you could make one change to improve Richland Parish over the next 10 or 20 years, what would it be?



Topic	Challenges Today	Ideas for Tomorrow
Parks & Recreation	What parks, trails, recreation facilities, or activities are missing? 	What new parks, programs, facilities, or amenities would you like to see? 
Health Care	What health care services are difficult to access and why? 	How can access to doctors, specialists, hospitals, or wellness services be improved? 
Public Safety	What public safety concerns affect your community? 	What investments or services would help residents feel safer? 
Education	What educational needs are not being met today? 	What programs, facilities, or partnerships could strengthen education and workforce readiness? 
Child Care	What challenges do families face when finding child care? 	What would make child care more accessible and affordable? 
Senior Services	What services or resources are lacking for older adults? 	What programs, housing options, or services would help seniors age in place? 
Broadband (Internet Access)	Where are internet access or reliability problems occurring? 	How can broadband access and digital connectivity be improved? 
Food Access	Where are there gaps in access to healthy and affordable food? 	What would improve access to grocery stores, farmers markets, or food assistance? 
Agriculture & Conservation	What natural resources, landscapes, or cultural assets are at risk? 	How should Richland Parish protect and enhance its natural environment? 